

TOEFL Reading Test 8

Please do the test in 55 minutes

Questions 1-12

Architecture has social purposes and meets practical needs by means of combining art and technological innovations. In building construction, however, an emergence of new materials does not make its precursors obsolete, and architectural knowledge is cumulative.

Line The fact that today much is constructed from prefabricated concrete does not do away with
(5) brick. Furthermore, despite dramatic changes and increased technological sophistication of architectural design and construction, the essential apparatus of erecting a building has remained rooted in preindustrial traditional practices passed down during the millennia. The social and utilitarian expectations of structures are largely based on elemental demands of keeping out elements and enemies, ameliorating the extremes of heat, and avoiding the
(10) intrusion of wind, precipitation, and pests.

Gravity, air pressure, and earthquakes can induce tensions that have to be accounted for when constructing functional enclosed space. Vertical stacking of masonry materials causes compression that can lead to important problems when a structure is spanned to build a roof and connect walls. Arches, vaults, and domes were specifically developed to alleviate
(15) the compression by directing the spanning element along a curve rather than a straight line. Building suspension structures, dams, and tunnels became possible in the nineteenth century with the increased availability of steel that could reinforce structural frames and enable them to withstand natural forces previously believed to be insurmountable.

Functional evolutions of modern buildings create new demands on the analysis of structural behavior and engineering. Few occupants of skyscrapers view elevators as elaborate
(20) systems of vertical transportation. Humidity and temperature control, forced ventilation, natural and artificial lighting, sanitation and disposal of waste, electrical wiring, and fire prevention make very tall constructions engineering marvels that also must be aesthetically pleasing and physically convenient.

Erecting a structure involves a great deal more than merely attending to the aesthetics and psychological experience of architectural space. The shape, size, and incombustibility of locally available construction materials fostered developments of specific technologies, and brick and stone masonry have evolved in response to the need for structural durability. Advances in civil engineering and knowledge associated with properties of building materials combine to lead to
(30) innovations in architectural design. Tools and skills required to exploit easily obtainable materials have continued to inform the development of modern industrialized technologies.

1. What is the main topic of the passage?
(A) The modern art of architecture and social pressure
(B) The profound importance of tradition in architectural
(C) The mutual impact of architecture and technology
(D) The great technological advances in building materials
2. The word “obsolete” in line 3 is closest in meaning to
(A) obvious
(B) obstinate
(C) antiquarian
(D) antiquated
3. The author mentions the word “brick” in line 5 as an example of which of the following?
(A) How old techniques can continue to remain practical
(B) How old buildings can coexist with modern architecture
(C) How new knowledge can supplant traditional technology
(D) How new design can improve traditional construction

4. It can be inferred from the passage that pragmatic requirements of buildings
 - (A) retain essential sophistication
 - (B) hold constant over time
 - (C) stagnate over millennia
 - (D) stay rooted in the elements
5. What can be inferred from the passage about reducing the effects of material compacting?
 - (A) Masonry is stacked vertically by increasing compression.
 - (B) Downward pressure is dispersed by semicircular roofs.
 - (C) Buildings are spanned to account for the force of gravity.
 - (D) Vertical roofs are bent to counteract air pressure.
6. The word “withstand” in line 18 is closest in meaning to
 - (A) endure
 - (B) enlarge
 - (C) withdraw
 - (D) withhold
7. The purpose of paragraph 3 is to suggest that
 - (A) tall buildings require large amounts of wiring to make them functional
 - (B) architectural innovations pose new challenges for technological development
 - (C) skyscrapers need to be appealing and convenient for their occupants
 - (D) architects of modern buildings create a demand for engineering talent
8. The word “marvels” in line 23 is closest in meaning to
 - (A) miracle
 - (B) mirage
 - (C) conception
 - (D) construction
9. According to the passage, what is one of the important requirements of building materials?
 - (A) They need to be large and well shaped.
 - (B) They should be locally produced.
 - (C) They do not affect human psychology.
 - (D) They have to be inflammable.
10. The word “fostered” in line 27 is closest in meaning to
 - (A) founded
 - (B) focused
 - (C) encouraged
 - (D) enveloped
11. It can be inferred from the passage that architecture and engineering
 - (A) are at the opposite ends of the technological spectrum
 - (B) go hand in hand to promote art and science
 - (C) compete for technological advancements
 - (D) supersede aesthetic and experiential values
12. The word “inform” in line 31 is closest in meaning to
 - (A) insist on
 - (B) infringe on
 - (C) contrast with
 - (D) contribute to

Questions 13-21

In the winter of 1848, James Marshall, a carpenter from New Jersey, was contracted by John Sutter to build a sawmill in Coloma in eastern California. On January 24, Marshall discovered gold on the mill grounds. He took his find to Sutter, who attempted to keep the news a secret and made his hired hands promise not to divulge it. However, Samuel Brannan, a shrewd San Francisco businessman, who owned a general store in the vicinity of Sutter's mill, saw potential for profit. In the spring, after hearing the rumors from the storekeeper in Coloma, Brannan hastily traveled to the Sacramento Valley and on his return widely disseminated the news about the untold riches in the diggings.

The first new arrivals assumed that the story of the gold was a hoax, and many were idle curiosity seekers. However, within weeks, scores of city dwellers began to move by ships and boats to reach the Coloma fort, and in subsequent months, rumors spread further down the coast of California, across the Mexican border, and to Hawaii. In eastern states, the press published reports of miners who struck it rich overnight so vast were the California gold deposits. Between 1848 and 1851, in all, around half a million fortune-seekers from around the globe descended on California to pursue instant wealth and thus took part in one of the largest migrations in history.

The accounts of the Sutter Mill deposits were not entirely untruthful. In December of 1848, President James Polk confirmed the news about the California gold in a statement to Congress, and the message was picked up by press agencies worldwide. Not all Forty-Niners, as the prospectors came to be known, made their journey in vain. The swath of gold-bearing quartz ran 100 miles wide along the Sierra Nevada mountain range and stretched from La Porte to Mariposa. During the initial stages of the Gold Fever, yields of \$300 to \$400 a day were not infrequent, and by the end of 1849, nearly \$10 million worth of deposits had been excavated. However, as competition for land claims increased, yields and profits began to drop off, and ore nuggets and dust began to disappear from dry streambeds and ravines. As mining operations became more laborious, individual prospectors were replaced by large commercial ventures, when groups of miners employed their penniless counterparts to divert and dry up rivers with strategically positioned dams and canals. The gold rush of 1849 was followed by the next wave of migrants headed to the Klondike region in Yukon Territory in mid-1897 to recover the gold at the conflation of two rivers.

13. The word “contracted” in line 1 is closest in meaning to
(A) empowered
(B) employed
(C) emboldened
(D) embodied

14. According to the passage, who was initially instrumental in diffusing accounts of Coloma gold?
(A) A carpenter
(B) A mill owner
(C) A merchant
(D) A business operator

15. In line 5, the word “vicinity” is closest in meaning to
(A) proximity
(B) propensity
(C) propriety
(D) profundity
16. The purpose of paragraph 2 is to demonstrate
(A) the suspicions of curiosity seekers
(B) the significance of population resettlement
(C) the influence of published press reports
(D) the wealth of gold deposits
17. The word “scores” in line 10 is closest in meaning to
(A) a greater good
(B) a great stock
(C) a great many
(D) a greater evil
18. It can be inferred from the passage that California gold had a variety of
(A) polemical and ecological outcomes
(B) proclamations and denunciations in the White House
(C) proponents and opponents in Congress
(D) political and economic ramifications
19. In line 20, the word “prospectors” is closest in meaning to
(A) entrepreneurs
(B) enthusiasts
(C) miners
(D) minions
20. It can be inferred from the passage that many Forty Niners
(A) acquired great wealth
(B) infected many laborers
(C) attained great dispositions
(D) inflated many recounts
21. The author of the passage implies that the California Gold Fever
(A) was a unique event in North American history
(B) was a singular event in the succession of others
(C) presented a lone occurrence on the North American continent
(D) preserved a unique page in North American development

Question 22-31

During the late Middle Ages, oil paint took hold as the artistic medium of choice because it was effective, flexible, and resilient relative to the wax-based, watercolor, fresco, or tempera paints prevalent at the time. Although contemporary commercially prepared paints contain a mixture of pigments and linseed oil, poppy oil paints are also available to con-

Line (5) noisseurs. The original recipes developed in medieval European monasteries relied on fast-drying bases derived from various organic oils predominantly valued for their medicinal qualities. The pigments are insoluble, lightproof, and chemically inert powders ground in the base. Occasionally, varnish can be added to increase the paste's ability to reflect light and to cover pictures with a protective seal. The resulting stiff, resinous compounds are

(10) often packaged in flexible metal or plastic tubes. Historically, yellow pigments have been added to the oil, and then the paste was layered over tin foil to imitate the appearance of gold leaf.

Despite the numerous experiments to accelerate the drying process, oil paints dry comparatively slowly with little color alteration. An important advantage of color stability is that

(15) tones and undertones are easy to blend, match, transpose, and grade, and mistakes and smudges are simple to correct. Due to the creamy consistency of most mixtures, artists can exploit their viscosity in thick applications, sprays, thin trickles, and three-dimensional blobs. The purification by boiling and filtering and bleaching of oils can impart varied hues to powdered pigments, while drying time can be reduced by adding metallic oxides.

(20) Professional painters who mix their own medium usually have their own trademark methods of mixing materials that art experts recognize as a part of an artist's creative work.

The thickness of the paste also plays an important role in defining the stages of painting a picture. After the basic design is sketched in pencil or charcoal, the broad background or foreground areas of the canvas are covered with thin, diluted paint on top of the primer. A

(25) thicker paint, often with added varnish, is subsequently used to refine and outline the foundation. The width of the brush depends on the type of paint the artist chooses to use, and stiff bristles are usually found in narrow brushes for making sharp lines, while softer brushes of animal hair can be employed in broad strokes.

22. What does the passage mainly discuss?

- (A) The evolution and history of oil paintings and media
- (B) The technology and development of drying oils
- (C) The recipes and ingredients for producing oil paints
- (D) The composition and techniques for mixing oil paints

23. It can be inferred from the passage that oil paintings

- (A) supplanted the use of tempera and fresco
- (B) took hold of the artistic choices in the Middle Ages
- (C) promoted artistic talent since the early times
- (D) supported the usefulness of applying paints

24. In line 4 and 5, the word “connoisseurs” is closest in meaning to
(A) explorers
(B) experts
(C) exporters
(D) experimenters
25. According to the passage, medieval monks extracted oil
(A) from minerals
(B) in conjunction with pigments
(C) from plants
(D) in combination with medicines
26. In line 8, the phrase “the base” is closest in meaning to
(A) paint
(B) oil
(C) chemicals
(D) pestle
27. The purpose of paragraph 2 is to illustrate
(A) the laboriousness of making oil paints
(B) the durability of oil colors
(C) the complexity of oil purification
(D) the superiority of oil paints
28. In line 17, the word “viscosity” is closest in meaning to
(A) stiffness
(B) elasticity
(C) stickiness
(D) eloquence
29. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as components of oil paints?
(A) accelerants
(B) retarders
(C) sealants
(D) glosses
30. In line 20, the word “trademark” is closest in meaning to
(A) signature
(B) selection
(C) significance
(D) secret
31. The author of the passage implies that an oil painting
(A) requires professional painters to mix their own paint
(B) contains a layer of canvas and charcoal
(C) thickens as the oil continues to dry in stages
(D) requires multiple layers of brushwork

Questions 32-41

Samuel Johnson's achievements in lexicography and writing have few rivals in English eighteenth-century literature. Johnson was born on September 18, 1709, in the family of a bookseller and stationer, and his education began informally among his father's books, as
Line Samuel was above all an insatiable reader. During his years at Pembroke College, Oxford,
(5) he acquired a reputation for prodigious learning and eccentricities that were as diverse as his reading. After being plagued by many ailments and emotional breakdowns, he was compelled to leave the college in poverty, and later in life, his despondency led him to a profound devotion to religion.

Following his father's death in 1731, Johnson tried his hand in teaching and attempted to
(10) run a school, but his early ventures met with rapid demise. When Johnson was twenty-six, he married Elizabeth Porter, a widow with a little fortune, who was twenty years his senior and who became the source of calm, support, and self-confidence in his life. In 1737 in London, Johnson began a life-long period of writing and lexicographic work that made him a figure of renown.

(15) To his contemporaries, Johnson was known as a man of large and unwieldy constitution and unpleasant manner. He recklessly dominated conversations, monopolized discussion topics, and boorishly overwhelmed opposing points of view. His antagonistic habits cost him many a friend. In 1747, burdened with extreme poverty, Johnson was commissioned to compile a dictionary by a consortium of booksellers who sought to raise their volume of
(20) sales. After eight years of obsessive and consuming labor, this monumental work with 40,000 entries with lucid, witty, occasionally spiteful, and idiosyncratic definitions, titled *Dictionary of the English Language*, saw the light of day in 1755. The remarkable, still-quoted lexicographic work with an enormous range of elucidating descriptions and illustrative exemplars became the imitable forerunner of how English language dictionaries are con-
(25) structed to this day.

During the nineteenth century, literary critics largely saw Johnson's literary contributions as slight with regard to their scholarly influence. It was perhaps Johnson's personal attributes that influenced the perspective through which he was portrayed. While his prose was viewed as dignified, vivid, and urbane, his vast body of work in poetry, novels, essays,
(30) tragedies, travelogues, biographies, diaries, and satire remained obscure until Joseph Krutch, an American critic, published a penetrating study *Samuel Johnson* in 1944. In 1978, Walter Bate won a Pulitzer Prize for his comprehensive psychological biography of Johnson that established him as rational, compassionate, and undaunted advocate of moral order and unceasing quest for truth.

32. What does the passage mainly discuss?
- (A) The life, ailments, and dictionary of Samuel Johnson
 - (B) Samuel Johnson's controversial character and work
 - (C) Samuel Johnson's contradictory traits and publications
 - (D) The family, commissions, and biographies of Samuel Johnson

33. In line 5, the word "prodigious" is closest in meaning to
- (A) immoral
 - (B) imminent
 - (C) immense
 - (D) immediate

34. In line 6, the word “plagued” is closest in meaning to
(A) diseased
(B) disfigured
(C) trampled
(D) tormented
35. It can be inferred from the passage that Samuel Johnson
(A) did not earn a college degree
(B) did not enter a prestigious college
(C) evaded unusual behaviors
(D) avoided extremes of emotion
36. According to the passage, Johnson’s marriage
(A) was a miserable failure due to poverty
(B) was motivated by convenience and money
(C) provided him a safe haven
(D) afforded him new writing venues
37. The word “antagonistic” in line 17 is closest in meaning to
(A) hallow
(B) heated
(C) hospitable
(D) hostile
38. According to the passage, the *Dictionary* descriptions of word meanings
(A) are emulated by modern lexicographers
(B) were not without peculiarities
(C) are considered exemplary by linguists
(D) were not consistently illustrated
39. The word “obscure” in line 30 is closest in meaning to
(A) offensive
(B) obtuse
(C) irrelevant
(D) irreverent
40. Which of the following is NOT mentioned among the genres of Johnson’s writing?
(A) Plays
(B) Biographies
(C) Quotations
(D) Articles
41. The word “slight” in line 27 is closest in meaning to
(A) trivial
(B) triumphant
(C) sinister
(D) solemn

Questions 42-50

Psychologists who work on motivation research a wide range of human traits and physiological characteristics that include the effects of hunger, reward, and punishment, as well as desires for power, tangible achievement, social acceptance, belongingness, self-esteem, and self-actualization. A plethora of hypotheses developed in the nineteenth and twentieth centuries have the goal of identifying causes of an organism's behavior that can be both conscious and unconscious. The hierarchical organization of human needs is a theoretical model, originally established by an American psychologist, Abraham Maslow, in 1954. The needs located at the bottom of the pyramid are the essentials of physiological survival that encompass oxygen, water, nutrition, rest, and avoidance of pain. Maslow's theory, grounded in research, also stipulated that these are variable and, at least to some extent, may explain, for example, food gratification. The second tier is rooted in the human need for safety, stability, and protection.

In the human life cycle, the needs for belonging are manifested in the desires to marry, have a family, belong in a community or among similarly minded people. In part, the need to belong can also show up in a search for particular types of occupations or careers. The next level of the hierarchy in effect deals with two substrata, where the first presumes the need for status, prestige, recognition, appreciation, and dominance, and the higher division includes a conglomeration of emotionally centered traits that pivot on competence, confidence, mastery, achievement, independence, and freedom.

The top tier is different from all others, and Maslow referred to it as growth motivation and self-actualization. At the highest level, individuals seek to realize and put to use their creativity, talent, leadership, curiosity, and understanding. At this level people can reach their full potentials and accurately perceive and accept reality, seek privacy and depth in personal relationships, resist enculturation, and develop social interests, compassion, and humanity. In many cases, self-actualizers do not lead ordinary lives, choose growth over safety, and cultivate peak experiences that leave their mark and change one for the better.

42. According to the passage, what does psychology of motivation attempt to uncover?
- (A) Reactions to hunger and desires for power
 - (B) Developments of human physiology and mind
 - (C) Reasons for human conduct and moving forces
 - (D) Organization of human society and hierarchies
43. The word “plethora” in line 4 is closest in meaning to
- (A) oversimplification
 - (B) overlap
 - (C) overreach
 - (D) overabundance
44. It can be inferred from the passage that in Maslow’s hierarchy
- (A) the first layer of needs dominates other tiers
 - (B) the highest level of the model supercedes the lower levels
 - (C) the second layer of needs is more urgent than the first
 - (D) the third level of the model is embedded in the fourth
45. The word “these” in line 10 refers to
- (A) theory and research
 - (B) rest and avoidance of pain
 - (C) oxygen, water, nutrition, and rest
 - (D) the lowest set of factors

46. The word “gratification” in line 11 is closest in meaning to
(A) gratitude
(B) pleasure
(C) gratuity
(D) pleasantry
47. It can be inferred from the passage that in modern-day terms, the second layer of needs can be reflected in people’s desire for
(A) a house in an upscale neighborhood
(B) a protected existence and dependence
(C) a measure of job and financial security
(D) a degree of friendship and family life
48. The word “conglomeration” in line 18 is closest in meaning to
(A) complex
(B) congress
(C) conjunction
(D) connotation
49. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a factor in human motivation?
(A) Esteem
(B) Participation
(C) Accomplishment
(D) Conformism
50. Which of the following conclusions is supported by the passage?
(A) Genuine self-actualizers may attain self-satisfaction.
(B) Sincere self-promoters can achieve full contentment.
(C) Real self-starters can achieve their lives’ desires.
(D) True self-actualizers may lead complicated lives.